NEAL OSWALD, CPA., ICD.D

Director · Senior Advisor · Digital Transformation · Financial Services

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EXECUTIVE PROFILE

Purpose-driven senior executive and advisor with 30+ years transforming financial institutions across retail and wholesale banking, capital markets, and FinTech. Trusted by bank CEOs, boards, and regulators to lead complex, multi-stakeholder change programs that are on time, on strategy, and built to last. Known for bridging strategy, technology, risk, finance, and operations to design and execute digital business models that deliver measurable results.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Digital Business Model Redesign	End-to-End Process Transformation
FinTech Advisory & CEO Coaching	Data, Analytics & Governance
Risk, AML & Regulatory Compliance	Agile Change & Transformation
Capital Markets & Treasury	Corporate Governance (ICD.D)

SELECTED ADVISORY & LEADERSHIP EXPERIENCE

Principal Advisor — FinTech CEOs & Financial Institutions | Wanilah Advisors Inc.

2022 – Present

- Advising multiple FinTech CEOs on go-to-market, product, and financial strategy; from concept through launch and early scaling.
- Leading digital business model redesign and operating model transformation engagements for FIs seeking to modernize end-to-end.
- Embedding agile mindsets, data governance frameworks, and automation playbooks across client organizations.
- Advisor to the CEO, Ownest.AI (2024–2025) and Canadian Red Cross Technology Advisor (2025).

COO & Head of Marketing and Communications | Concentra Bank

2018 – 2021

- Led the operating model redesign and digital bank launch, including the full end-to-end (ETE) client experience and employee enablement strategy.
- Established Centres of Excellence for Data & Analytics, Change Execution, and Automation.
- Developed and deployed a FinTech partner onboarding playbook, accelerating third-party integrations.
- Delivered new brand, value propositions, differentiation strategy, and product roadmaps in the Marcomm mandate.
- Deployed agile methods across multiple concurrent business transformation programs.

SVP — Transformation | CIBC

2009 – 2014

- Drove transformational change across three divisions: Wholesale Banking, Retail Banking, and Technology & Operations.
- Led ETE process management for Retail and Business Banking — improving operating leverage, client experience, and employee enablement.
- Built inline operational analytics for the Mortgage Line of Business; designed future-state client journeys and CX design principles.

- Served as Interim CFO for UK operations: automated statutory and management reporting; implemented systems and process improvements.

Partner & Practice Lead — Banking and Capital Markets Advisory | PwC / Ernst & Young / EDS *1989 – 2008*

- Led FSI advisory practices at E&Y (Partner), EDS (Global Risk Practice Lead), and PwC (Partner, Banking & Capital Markets) over a combined 19 years.
- Executed major risk, treasury, and capital markets transformations across large global banks in North America, Europe, and Asia.
- Deployed BPM, RPA, AML/KYC workflow, and market risk systems (Algorithmics VAR) at multiple Tier 1 banks.
- Implemented RAROC, EVA/SVA, and regulatory capital (Basel II) frameworks; designed funds transfer pricing and cost allocation methodologies.
- Completed large-scale programs including Y2K, post-merger integrations, and global Basel II rollouts with cross-border, multi-stakeholder scope.

BOARD & ADVISORY POSITIONS

Arthritis Society Canada | National Board — Audit & Finance Committee Chair *2019*

Workplace Safety & Prevention Services (WSPS) | Vice Chair, Audit & Finance; Technology & Innovation Committee *2021 – 2023*

Canadian Red Cross | Technology Advisor *2025*

Ownest.AI | Advisor to the CEO *2024 – 2025*

THOUGHT LEADERSHIP & PUBLICATIONS

- Journal of Digital Banking (Summer 2016): "Leave the Past Behind with Digital Process Management," Henry Stewart Publications.
- Speaker, IRM/UK BPM Conference: "Digital Process Management" (June 2016).
- Digital Strategy studies: Customer Communications Management and modern microservices/data architectures for financial institutions.

CAREER TIMELINE

2022 – Present	Wanilah Advisors Inc. — Principal & Senior Advisor
2018 – 2021	Concentra Bank — COO & Head of Marketing and Communications
2014 – 2021	Wanilah Advisors Inc. — Advisor; AlixPartners Alliance
2009 – 2014	CIBC — SVP; Transformation across Wholesale, Retail & Tech & Ops
2008 – 2009	Wanilah Advisors Inc. — Co-Founder, Independent Consulting
2005 – 2008	PwC — Partner, Banking & Capital Markets Advisory Practice Lead
2003 – 2005	EDS — Global Risk Practice Lead
1995 – 2003	Ernst & Young — Partner; FSI Practice Lead / Cap Gemini VP
1993 – 1995	CIBC — Global FX & Money Markets Controller
1989 – 1993	Woods Gordon / Ernst & Young — Principal, Capital Markets Practice
1985 – 1989	Bank of Nova Scotia — NACB Controller & Special Projects
1982 – 1985	Clarkson Gordon — Audit, Financial Services Sector

EDUCATION & PROFESSIONAL DESIGNATIONS

ICD.D — Institute of Corporate Directors | *2021*

HBA — Honours Business Administration, University of Western Ontario | *1982*

CA / CPA — Chartered Accountant / CPA | *1985*
CFA — Chartered Financial Analyst (Retired) | *1990*
CMC — Certified Management Consultant (Retired) | *1992*